

# The Big Deal

If each byte of data that we generate every day were to be a grain of sand, we could double the quantity of sand on earth in a mere 3 days. That is the extent to which the present day world of technology is driven by data. And most of that data, even up to 90% according to some studies, has been generated in the last couple of years. That comes as no surprise thanks to the explosive increase in the sale of smartphones, wearables and other smart devices. The world didn't take time to realise the potential of all this data and hence, the field of Big Data was born.

Big Data has been the buzzword of the information technology industry for some time now, yet there is little or no awareness regarding the actual internals and implications of this technology. Through this issue of Fastrack, we have attempted to create a basic guide to Big Data, after reading which you shall be ready to roll your sleeves up to pursue the field if you chose to do so.

Chapter 1 and 2 take you through the basics of Big data and clear out the jargon that the technology is accompanied by. The different types of big data and their sources are also explained. Most of us are aware that Relational Databases were already doing the job of dealing with data for enterprises. Chapter 3 highlights why exactly that failed with Big Data and how Big Data technologies evolved from the failure of Relational Databases.

Hadoop has been synonymous with Big Data for most of us, so much so that many of us can't differentiate between the two. Chapter 4 takes you from the emergence of Hadoop to its future potential, while explaining what makes it the successful piece of Big Data technology that it is.

Chapters 5 through 9 highlight and showcase the various fields in which Big Data has been successfully used to achieve monetary gains as well as greater impact. Fields as diverse as education and banking have benefited by implementing Big Data technology into their systems. This Chapter also shows you the possible benefits that are yet to be reaped in all these fields.